



The Western Champion

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SIXPENCE

Notes and Comments.

"Rum and Cloves" is the rather suggestive title adopted by the new editor of the Clermont paper for his funny column.

A STORY comes from Tasmania to the effect that the residents of Port Arthur are excited over the discovery of a gold nugget in the gizzard of a teal shot in the district, and are indulging in all sorts of golden visions.

THE Warrego Pastoralists' Association is still offering rewards of £550 for information concerning the burning of woolsheds and wagons in their district during the strike.

It is stated another supply of artesian water has been struck on Cambridge Downs station at a depth of a little over 600 feet, the daily flow being about 100,000 gallons. This is the fourth successful bore put down on the station.

WE have often amused ourselves with what the bushmen call a "gig" at the late editor of the *Worker*, but, under his management, the paper was readable and spicy, though caustic and sometimes spiteful. But now!—the ads. are the most interesting portions of the paper.

THE scoured fleeces competing for the challenge prize of £100 given by the Deniliquin Pastoral Society have been valued by wool experts. The prize has again been won by Austin and Millar, of Wanganella, with a fleece weighing 12 lbs. 7 ozs. of scoured wool, beating all previous records.

A CANTASSER for the Sydney *Bulletin* was knocked down by a train last week and killed. The *Bulletin* has often had a grim joke about the violent destruction of other literary people's cantassers, and this accident will probably furnish the subject for a comic cartoon.

RABBITS are increasing rapidly around Cunnamulla, and they appear to be travelling up the river. The sandhills and dry parts of the Warrego River bed are covered with tracks. Several have been killed in that neighborhood during the past month.

FORBES, of the Welcome Hotel, Longreach, is a rash speculator. In the Thompson Handicap he backed on the totalisator every horse in the race. There were six starters, and it cost him £3, but as the dividend was £9 17s. he was £3 17s. in by the transaction.

THERE were only thirty members in the House when the Colonial Treasurer delivered his budget speech. We have often had a budget speech before from Sir Thomas, but his finance has always produced the same result—an increased expenditure and a falling revenue.

THE Sydney *Bulletin* says:—A Mr. and Miss Heller have been performing in Victoria, the gentleman calling himself Robert Heller's nephew, whereupon Heller's brother, Palmer, the Hamilton solicitor, denies the relationship. These are the Hellers who performed for a few nights at Barcaldine this year.

AFFAIRS in connection with the Melbourne Mercantile Bank are beginning to look very black. It is now asserted that though the late Chairman, Sir M. H. Davies, had no actual overdraft of his own, yet companies in which he was interested or dominated owed the bank some £300,000. Other charges are openly hinted at, and the return of Sir Mathew is evidently awaited with anxiety.

It is not the shearer and rouseabout who needs to growl at the increased taxation imposed by the Colonial Treasurer. A man who earns 30s. a week and his tucker won't suffer much by £1 per ton on flour or 3d. per gallon on kerosene. It is the married man, the laborer with a family, who feels the pinch, and it is pretty severe upon him whether he is a carrier or a printer, or whether he earns his living driving a team or a steam engine.

THE subscribers to the local hospital at St. George are flooding the local paper with epistles crying out against tyranny, injustice and general incapacity of the committee, who at their last meeting voted £10 as a bonus to the hard-working domestic who cooks, scrubs, washes and generally does for the patients for about half the money a rouseabout gets for brooming up the floor after the shearer.

WE should like to suggest to the ardent Separationists in Rockhampton that they can go one better than the Government, and besides importing everything direct from London produce in the Central District much of what is needed for consumption. If they will turn their attention from gold mines to wheat-producing and maize and potato growing in the western districts, it would benefit them and the country people to an extent of which at present they have a most feeble conception.

A SECOND letter by the Right Hon. W. E. Gladstone has appeared in the journal *Il Popolo*, in Rome, in which he criticises adversely the Triple Alliance, alluding to it as a trick of the fallen German Chancellor. A great sensation has been caused by the publication of the letter in Germany and Austria. The Russian journals are jubilant, as well as the French.

INTELLIGENCE has been received of the fact that Messrs. Redfern, Alexander & Co., owing to the pressure of their liabilities, which amount to £250,000, had been obliged to seek the protection of the Bankruptcy Court. The firm's Australian business in 1891 had been very large, and included 24,000 bales wool, including 13,000 bales from New Zealand; but since then business had been gradually declining.

IN connection with the safe robbery from Matchett and Co., of North Melbourne, and which in addition to the £110 cash, contained silver and more than £1000 worth of documents, including deposit receipt for £500, bank book, insurance policies, and licenses, the robbers showed great consideration for the firm, for, instead of destroying the documents, they posted them in a letter-box in St. Kilda, where they were found by a mail-collector afterwards.

TWENTY kanakas waited on the Bowen police magistrate on Tuesday and asked that they be granted exemption tickets to be allowed to follow general agricultural pursuits, from which they are at present debarred by the regulations recently issued. Half of these men have been 15 years, and the other half nine years in the colony. Some said they would return to their islands if the request was not granted. The Police Magistrate has promised to refer the matter to the Colonial Secretary.

MR. EDWARD LOWRY, clerk in the employment of Messrs. Singer and Co.'s factory, received word at Rockhampton from Sydney that he had the good fortune to draw Donation in Adams' consultation sweep on the Spring Handicap at the Sydney Tattersall's Club race meeting, which was run on Saturday. Donation won the race, and Mr. Lowry will receive about £3438. No one was in partnership with him in the ticket, and he did not "lay off" any of the money.

A SUGAR-GROWER complains thus:—The law relating to the employment of kanakas as it now stands is impracticable, cruel, unjust and foolish. Here is an example. A kanaka can drive a horse, but a white man must put on (millowners) can cart cane on the public road with kanakas. I cannot because I grow cane for sale, and expect to be paid for it. The millowner could cart my cane, if bought on the ground, with kanakas, because he is not carting it for sale.

HERE is a chance for some of the Barcaldine trombone players:—A monster brass band contest of £100 is advertised to take place in Gympie on Monday and Tuesday, December 26 and 27. The first prize is £50, and carries with it a gold medal to the conductor; the second prize is £30, and the third £20. Entrance, £1 1s. There are "sets of waltzes" prize £3; and for the best "march past," £3. Entrance to the special prizes is free. Arrangements are being made to allow bands to travel at reduced rates.

IN the Railway Commissioners' annual report we find the following having reference to the Central Railway:—Section 9 was completed and the line opened to Longreach, the present Western terminus of the Central Railway, 425 miles from Rockhampton, on the 15th February, 1892. As the whole of the receipts from this line from beginning to end is entirely dependent upon traffic derived from pastoral settlement, the results of its workings have been most gratifying. The receipts, after paying interest on capital and working expenses, leave a net profit of £34,067.

A GENTLEMAN, who was recently sentenced to six months for obtaining goods under false pretences and released under the First Offenders Probation Act, was present lately at a quite too spirit ball given by a grandee of Rockhampton. Among the guests there was also an officer of police, who saw with horror and amazement the young man, who had recently reported himself, dancing a waltz with his daughter of the house. When the music stopped he interviewed the first offender, and ordered him to immediately leave the house. We were wondering what would have happened if his lordship had refused.

A DEPUTATION waited upon Mr. Unmack last week to urge upon the Government the construction of the middle section of the Gladstone-Bundaberg railway. One of the speakers referring to the third section said:—"It has been very nearly itself; even the gang which took it has gone." It has become overgrown with weeds, and if a bush fire took place it would be destroyed. Mr. Unmack said that the sum of money would be in great danger of being destroyed. Mr. Unmack said that the sum of money would be in great danger of being destroyed. Mr. Unmack said that the sum of money would be in great danger of being destroyed.

A ROCKHAMPTON lady found herself placed in an awkward position the other day. One of her admirers entering the drawing-room unannounced, surprised a rival Lothario in the act of nursing the fair hostess. The two unregistered candidates were arranging a settlement under Marquis of Queensberry rules, and the lady was imploring each of them to spare the other for her sake, when the real husband burst upon the scrimmage. An explanation followed in a feeble manner. She said the strangers had both called to tune the piano, and were fighting to see which should tune it first.

SEVERAL terms from Ipswich have gone out west in order to fulfil engagements (says the *Warwick Examiner*), consequent upon the increased demand for carriers in the Western districts as a result of the shearing season having now been entered upon. Since then others have left for the same quarter. By Thursday night week's western goods trains, four waggon with bullocks were conveyed from Ipswich. On Friday week a train left Eak for Charleville with a full load of working bullocks which are required by those who have gone out to undertake wool carrying for the pastoralists.

THE *Worker* mentions that Mr. Lane, its late editor, left Brisbane on Tuesday last for Townsville, whence he makes direct for Hughenden to begin his six months tour amongst the western sheds in search of recruits for New Australia, Buenos Ayres. It is needless to say he carries with him the sympathy of his mates throughout the move. It is a pity, but Lane is not able to convert Casey and Seymour, and induce them to migrate to New Australia. The country would just suit Gilbert, who he would have to keep his six-shooter ready at a moment's notice.

MR. THOMAS GLASSEY, M.L.A., as chairman of the Labour Convention which recently sat in Brisbane, forwarded the following resolution to Sir Samuel Griffith:—"That this Convention is of the opinion that the time has arrived when the union prisoners, without exception, should be released." The Premier has caused his receipt of the resolution to be acknowledged, and he has in doing so directed attention to the fact that no reasons were given in it why the prisoners should be released before the expiration of the period of their sentences.

THE Tenterfield Intercolonial Chilled Meat Company, Limited, have issued a prospectus of the second issue of 5000 shares. The increasing of the capital of this company from £5000 to £10,000 (of which in the second issue only 3000 shares of £1 are to be called in) has been decided upon by the original shareholders, consequent on the present plant and accommodation not being sufficiently large to carry on their increasing business. The output, now that the company is in good working order, taking last month's returns as an example, is as follows:—502 cattle and 1016 sheep were treated, showing a profit to the company for the month, after providing for all expenses, of £100 14s. 6d.

"FASHIONABLE WOOL" is the heading of a letter from its London correspondent in one of the Sydney daily papers. The wool to which the term "fashionable" is applied is that from Queensland, neither too fine nor too strong, neither too long nor too short, and which, according to the writer, was eagerly sought for and purchased at last sales both by Americans and Yorkshire manufacturers. It will be remembered that last year the whole of the Northampton Downs clip was purchased for America at an average of 10d. to 10½d. per pound. That clip would therefore appear to be the description of wool designated "fashionable" in the letter referred to.

MR. H. Y. L. BROWN discovered some fossils in the Far North during his recent camel journey of two months' duration (says the *South Australian Register*). The primary object of his tour was to look for indications of coal-bearing country, and the sides of waterholes and creek banks were carefully examined. In the neighborhood of Mr. Cave's station, at the Warburton, he followed a watercourse for fifty miles and unearthed many fossils. Chief of them were relics of that extinct monster the Dipododon. Part of a thighbone was found, and also a portion of the jaw, with four teeth in a splendid state of preservation. The ivory, which is darker than ordinary teeth, does not show the least sign of decay, and the bone in which the teeth are fixed is also firm. The teeth are very large, indicating that the animal was of huge proportions.

IN the South Australian Legislative Assembly on Wednesday week the Premier of that colony said, in reply to a question, that he would ascertain if it was the intention of the Queensland Government to put a duty on flour. Before this time he has ascertained. The subject seems to affect somebody down there; they don't like it. It is protection operating against themselves. They can do with any amount of protection in their own favor; but there is none of the federal spirit in other people protecting "Number One." The South Australians have put a stiff duty on live stock going over the border from Queensland, but they are averse to any duty on flour from that country on its entry into Queensland. At the same time the South Australian Government had before it a proposal to impose a duty on wheat with the object of keeping Victoria's wheat from competing with their own.

THERE is a man up Chinchilla way (says the *Daily Herald*) who has neither vote nor interest in elections, whose name is sufficient to give anyone six months in gaol who is heard using it; and whose breath is warranted to "move" ten tons. This individual designates himself "the promoter of the great organisation for political reform." Last week, we learn, he visited the Christian-borg sawmills trying to get a petition signed praying for something like the suspension of the Governor, the abolition of all members of Parliament who can afford to pay their way, and a big social upheaval generally. We are not informed whether a reward has yet been offered for the capture of this "political reformer," or whether he is regarded as harmless.

THE operations of the Sydney Government Labor Bureau during the six months it has been in existence form the subject of an exhaustive report just presented to the acting Colonial Secretary. Some indication of the usefulness of the bureau is the fact that 5788 men have been found employment through its agency. Altogether 13,400 men have been registered on the books, but these figures, it is explained, do not show the actual number who are still left on the books by about 3000. A considerable number of men have been absorbed by works which are being carried out in and around the metropolis. During the past week a number of men were sent away to Wentworth, where they will be employed on the bridge now being completed by the Government. So soon as arrangements at this job are completed, a further contingent of men will be sent from the bureau. About 600 men sleep in the Exhibition Building nightly.

A COONAMBLE correspondent writes to the *Maitland Mercury*:—Shearing is in full swing at Bullara, Messrs. A. Tobin and Sons' great station in the Castlereagh district. Previously to the roll call, it was estimated that about 250 men—shearers, rouseabouts, and nondescripts of all ages—were camped there, the majority of whom were "hard ups" while many were in a pitiable plight of destitution. True to the traditions of their name and place, the Messrs. Tobin distributed rations with a lavish hand—a bag, and even a bag and a half of flour being served out to the famishing crowd, while twenty sheep per diem were sacrificed to this fearful necessity. It appears to be agreed on all hands that the supply of labor this season is far in excess of the demand. Entirely disregarding of Union rules, Union rates, and Unionist altogether men by the scores are simply begging for work—even offering to work for bare subsistence, in preference to rambling through the country, cast upon a precarious charity. A different state of matters, however, was recently shown at Bimble, where the rouseabouts struck for a minimum wage of 25s. per week and got it.

A YEAR or two ago, when the Atkinson (New Zealand) Government was on the down grade, it started to distribute every possible billet among its friends and hangers-on, and among the rest it appointed a sixth Judge of the Supreme Court, whereas the law only allowed for five. One of the existing Judges, however, was aged and shaky, and the Atkinson Cabinet, by its new appointment, practically gave away his billet in advance, so that the hated Ballance might have the office to dispose of when the old Judge died. But the old Judge wouldn't die, and the new Law Officers decided that there was no money to pay the salary of the extra Judge. The Atkinson tried to pass a special Bill, but it failed. Then the Ballance Cabinet was formed, and declined to recognise the Judge who had been appointed. As he positively refused to resign, he simply allowed to go on sending in his bill without any salary. Alleged friends of the Government, and the Supreme Court decided that he wasn't a legally authorized Judge, and that there was nothing due to him. Next, he appealed to the Privy Council and was defeated there also; and, after that, he stopped down and went back to the bar, and tried to take up his forsaken practice.

DURING an interview with Max O'Reil, the French author and lecturer, in Brisbane on Friday week last, he told the following story which serves well to show the hollowness of some would-be democrats:—The conversation turned on the colonies. "What strikes me most," said Max, "is the agglomeration of superfluous population in your cities"—he was referring to the whole of the capitals. "It is the same, too, in England. People prefer to hang round, week after week, month after month, and they will not go away from the centres of population. The cause, as compared with France? Well, I will tell you a little tale. I was not so long ago at Broken Hill, and I spoke to a man on strike. I asked him what his wages were, and he replied £3 per week. I told him: 'My friend, for eight months of my life I had only £2 a week, and I had to dress better than you do, for it was an essential of earning that sum that I should not be shabbily dressed. Although I had only £2 a week I managed to live on 30s., and if I lived in Broken Hill and only received £3 a week I should manage to live so that at the end of twelve months I should have £75, with which I should buy shares in one of your mines. You talk about the mines belonging to the people. But you prefer to take your £3 and wash it down your throat in whisky and gin and brandy.' Well, you cannot spend it and have it too." The man replied that I was not a democrat. I replied that I, on the con-

trary, was a true democrat, and that the truest democracy was that by which a man was his own master. A man could not be his own master who never had a few shillings in his own pocket.

THE Charleville *Times* records the death from sugar diabetes of Mr. Henry Green of Walla, known throughout the whole of the western districts. The deceased gentleman some three months ago through the slackness in trade became insolvent, which apparently weighed very much on his mind, and he lost his reason, so much so that he had to be taken to the reception house, where he died on Sunday, August 14th. Harry Green came to Charleville about fifteen years ago as a carrier, and followed that avocation for a period of about five years, when he retired. He then went to Walla, and built a public house where he carried on business until his misfortune. The deceased gentleman was universally liked, and his decease will be regretted by many. Though of a quiet and unassuming disposition, he was a very popular man, and was very charitable in all his dealings. One peculiar trait of his character was that when he had done a good action he courted no after reference to it, and did not, as is too often the case in the present day, give for the simple reason of receiving the approbation of his fellow men. In the local race meetings a few years ago his name was always amongst the winners, and the Walla club was worked solely by himself, in which he took a very great interest, and the absence of his kindly face and his wonted presence, will no doubt be felt by his friends in these institutions. During his long connection in Charleville he has borne the highest character and integrity, and while avoiding public life, he has been able to offer a good opinion on many leading topics. He leaves a wife and five children to mourn their loss.

THE remaining eight members of the crew of the wrecked barque Newfield were safely landed just before dark on Tuesday night, and shortly afterwards the lifeboat arrived. The vessel struck at Peterborough, near where the Schomburgk was wrecked many years ago. The captain, who was on deck at the time of the disaster, mistook Cape Nelson light for the light on King Island. She struck at 2 o'clock in the morning, and remained stuck about 200 yards from the shore; the night was squally and boisterous. A lifeboat was immediately lowered, and was almost instantly dashed to pieces, and two of the sailors, who were in the boat at the time, were drowned. Another lifeboat was then launched with all hands aboard, but she also was immediately swamped, and nine more, including Captain Scott, were drowned; the remainder scrambled aboard the wreck. At daylight the jollyboat was manned, and eight of the crew reached Schomburgk Reef. Three of these attempted to pull back to rescue the remaining eight on the wreck, but the boat foundered, and the men succeeded in swimming ashore. Immediately the news was brought to Pt. Campbell the rocket apparatus was despatched to the scene of the wreck; but rocket firing proved to be a complete failure, and eventually the remaining eight who were on board launched another boat and steered for Schomburgk Reef, but the boat swamped and the occupants swam ashore.

WANGANUI, New Zealand, a forgotten little city that sleeps among interminable sand hills, got up a race meeting a few weeks ago, and the principal gentleman amateur distinguished himself in various unexpected ways. As he was an extensive advertiser, however, he was let down easily by the press; but when he rushed into the editor's office with thunder in his eye, and a crumpled paper in his hand, a terrible fear suddenly arose that he hadn't been let down easy enough. "Look here," he hollered, as he executed an impromptu *pas seul* all over the room, "this dashed reporter of yours says I lost my reins in that infernal steeplechase. What's the meaning of it? Who's responsible for this miserable outrage? Who did it? I'm going for the fellow, whoever he is!" The editor assumed an attitude of shocked surprise. "Assured me, you don't mean to say that such a groundless assertion?" "Oh dash the assertion! What I want to know is, who did it? 'I assure you, my dear sir, that the unprincipled liar who perpetrated that—' 'Oh, blow the unprincipled liar! You passed the thing, sir. You're responsible. You say there that I lost my reins, and yet you were on the ground yourself, and if you weren't blind, you might have seen that I let the animal bolt with me at the start. I lost my hat, too, only you were afraid to say it. I lost my head into the bargain! Did you see that you—you—you dashed Ananias! I lost my saddle and my stirrups and burst my collar, and I came home laughing by the horse's mane, and all the crowd booed, and somebody threw a hunk of mud at me, and when I fell off at the last jump I saw you—roo, sir, just falling to pieces with laughter. I was drunk—hopelessly drunk—if you want to know what was the matter, and you saw it all, and there's no dashed excuse for your conduct in not publishing a correct account of the proceedings. Don't let this sort of thing happen again, please. Come out and I'll show you. You're not fit to be trusted with a newspaper." And the editor went out and was shouted for like a man drinking in a dream.

THE South Queensland (Ipswich) *Wine*—Red and white in the market. They are highly recommended and are respectfully of Wine and Spirit.

Aramac Divisional Board.

FRIDAY, AUGUST 12, 1892.

PRESIDENT: The Chairman (Mr. S. P. Fraser), and Messrs. E. B. Edkins, W. H. J. Harding, J. C. M'Whannell, S. Sharwood, J. S. Henderson, J. W. Booker and W. H. Looker.

The RETURNING-OFFICER announced that Mr. S. Sharwood had been duly elected for Subdivision No. 1 *vis* Mr. E. H. King, resigned; and Mr. Sharwood took his seat.

Minutes of meetings 13th May, 10th June and 5th August were read and confirmed.

Correspondence read, adopted and received.

The Under-Secretary for Lands wrote under date 2nd June, and the Clerk was instructed to reply that this Board is still of opinion that the road down the western side of the Thompson River to Windarah should be opened for various reasons, the principal of which are as follows, viz.—1st. That it forms part of the main stock route in this district; and 2nd. that in wet seasons it will admit traffic, while the road on the eastern side of the river is practically closed.

Resolved, That a reserve of 320 acres be applied for in connection with the Iffracombe dam.

Resolved, That the work of sinking the Iffracombe dam be discontinued as soon as it reaches a depth of 20 feet; the necessary troughing and wire for the dam completion thereof to be procured at once and placed on the ground.

Resolved, That the selection of a pump and troughing, and everything in connection therewith, be left in the hands of a sub-committee formed of members of Sub-division No. 1.

Mr. J. C. M'WHANNELL laid a letter on the table from Messrs. S. Williams and Co., of Rockhampton, accompanied with a book, giving information in connection with pumps, &c., and the Clerk was directed to thank Messrs. Williams and Co.

In the matter of making water on the Iffracombe-Ipsford road sundry letters were read, including those from the hon. sec. of the Iffracombe Progress Association and Mr. W. H. Mayers, and it was resolved that a sub-committee be appointed, consisting of Messrs. J. C. M'Whannell, S. Sharwood and J. S. Henderson, such sub-committee to be vested with full power to make provision for the construction of two dams on the Iffracombe-Ipsford road, on sites to be selected by the overseer under their direction; or, as an alternative, to construct one dam and purchase any other dam which may seem to them advisable.

The Under-Secretary for Lands wrote on the 17th May that the maps in the Surveyor-General's Department had been marked for reservation in future surveys of a road through Henry Downs and Goodberry Lower run; and the Clerk was instructed to communicate with the Minister for Lands, and request that the road be proclaimed open for traffic.

Resolved, That the overseer be instructed to erect gates on the above road.

With reference to the extension of the Iffracombe reserve, the Under-Secretary for Lands wrote on 4th July refusing to grant the request made by the Board on the 2nd June, and it was resolved that Messrs. Jas. Crombie and T. Ryan and B. G. Casey, M.M.L.A., be requested to interview, as a deputation, the Minister for Lands, pointing out that the present area of the reserve (1280 acres) is altogether inadequate, and that an extension of 20 square miles at least be granted; also that two large dams are about to be put down on the Iffracombe-Ipsford road, which will make another important addition to the fast-increasing traffic to Iffracombe.

A letter bearing date 12th May, and signed by Messrs. J. W. Chadwick of Tuarburra, Mareland and Chadwick, P. Cameron, (Dalmore), E. G. Blume (Bexley) and three other ratepayers, was considered; and it was resolved that the overseer be instructed to open the road from Camoola to Longreach via Tuarburra on the western side of the Thompson River; and that he give notice to the selectors to erect gates where necessary, also to make provision for the traffic on such road by making crossing-places over creeks and gullies where necessary.

The manager of Isla Downs wrote on the 12th June, and the Clerk was instructed to reply that this Board will authorise the payment of £10 towards repairing the Barcoo crossing at Portland Downs, as the Board's overseer estimates that the crossing can be put in good repair for a sum of £20.

Letter from Corona, signed by Messrs. Main and Leamouth and B. E. Lane, Verge-mont, *re* opening up and clearing the Diamantina Ganges-Longreach road from Vergemont to Longreach; and it was resolved that, on the completion of the tank work at Iffracombe, or as soon as Sub-overseer Dillon can be spared, he be instructed to open up the road mentioned, and the Clerk to communicate with Mr. Campbell informing him that the overseer cannot commence the work till say about the middle of September; but that if he and his neighbors desire the work to be commenced before that time, he is authorised to get the work carried out on the lines he proposed. The Clerk to instruct Sub-overseer Dillon to proceed with his party along the road between Longreach to Darr River Junction, near Maneroo, to make the necessary cuttings at Dingo and the two other creeks; there to go on towards Corona and open the road out to Silcoe, seeing Mr. Campbell as to direction of road, &c., and after working out to Silcoe as to ensure the traffic being carried out to return, and on his way back carry out all permanent work at the various crossings. The overseer received authority to purchase three or four fresh horses on account of Sub-division No. 3 for the above work.

Mr. M'Whannell wrote, under date 22nd July, calling attention to the bad state of Dingo Creek and other crossings on the Maneroo-Longreach road. It was resolved that he be advised that the necessary repairs will be effected as soon as possible; overseer Dillon to be instructed to proceed with the Longreach-Camoola road after he has completed the crossing on the Maneroo-Longreach road.

Mr. A. E. Macdonald wrote from Fernoy, under date 27th June, *re* the opening of a road from Fernoy to Winton via Warrambool Downs. The Clerk was instructed to reply that the matter will receive prompt attention when the plan of the road comes to hand.

In response to letters from Messrs. J. M'Aniff and Saml. Payne respectively, the overseer was authorised to get the crossing made on the Aramac Creek on the road from Powell to Aramac, cost not to exceed £20, and also attend to the repairs required in Porter-street, Aramac, the work in both cases to be under the supervision of the overseer.

Mr. S. SHARWOOD moved and Mr. W. H. LOOKER seconded, "That the footpaths of

Longreach be extended from Eagle-street down Duck-street to Galar-street and both sides of Galar-street to the railway station, also a crossing to be made in the main street as near the centre of the town as possible. Carried. Messrs. E. B. Edkins and J. S. Henderson dissenting.

Mr. S. SHARWOOD referred to the goat nuisance at Longreach, and moved "That the Clerk be instructed to communicate with the inspector, inform him his duties, and direct his attention to Clause 5 of By-law No. 17." Seconded by Mr. J. S. HENDERSON.

Mr. W. ST. J. HARDING moved and Mr. J. C. M'WHANNELL seconded, as an amendment, "That the Clerk be instructed to direct the inspector to carry out his instructions to the letter and impose all stray stock and goats, and demand registration fees." The Board divided on the amendment with the following result:—For: Messrs. E. B. Edkins, J. C. M'Whannell and W. St. J. Harding. Against: Messrs. S. Sharwood and J. S. Henderson. The amendment was, therefore, declared carried.

Resolved, That the Board assist the Longreach Progress Association in obtaining an extension of the Longreach Town Reserve by an addition of 20 square miles, by recommending the application to the Minister for Lands.

Mr. John Wills wrote, under date 16th May, asking for the appointment of pumper *re* scheme for supplying the town of Longreach with water. The Clerk was instructed to hand the letter over to Mr. S. Sharwood.

Mr. James Thompson was granted permission to erect verandah in front of his premises, situated on the corner of Eagle and Pelican streets, Longreach, subject to the usual conditions.

Messrs. Lucas and Co. and Lloyd-Jones wrote on the 8th ultimo *re* giving access to their agricultural farms, Longreach. The overseer was directed to inspect and report at the next meeting of the Board.

Four applications were opened for the appointment of inspector for town of Muttaharra and reserve, which resulted in the election of Mr. W. H. Langdon.

Reports of overseers and inspectors for Longreach, Aramac, Muttaharra and Arrillah, together with the barrcutters reports, were read and received.

The Clerk was directed to issue instructions *re* grants to all inspectors.

Mr. J. S. HENDERSON remarked on the duties of the various inspectors of the Division, and suggested that the Board should consider at a future date the advisableness of restricting the inspectors to do no work other than that of the Board.

Resolved, That in future sub-overseer Dillon and his plant be kept entirely in Sub-division No. 3, and to do no other work outside that Sub-division as far as practicable.

In the matter of artesian bore tubing borrowed from the Board by Coreena and Leichhardt about 18 months ago, the Clerk reported that the dispute in each case as to quantity had been settled, and it was resolved that in the future no plant or anything the property of the Board be lent, but if not required may be sold at cost price.

With reference to the purchase of some draught horses about two years ago, of which there was one horse short delivered, Mr. John Cameron, the vendor, explained that he held the Board blameless for the non-payment thereof.

Mr. HARDING moved and Mr. LOOKER seconded, That no rate be struck for the current year.

Mr. BOOKER moved and Mr. HENDERSON seconded, as an amendment, That a rate be struck for the current year in Sub-divisions Nos. 1 and 2, omitting Sub-division No. 3. The Board divided on the amendment with the following result, viz.:—For: Messrs. M'Whannell, Henderson, Sharwood and Booker. Against: Messrs. Harding, Edkins and Looker. The amendment was, therefore, declared carried.

Mr. HENDERSON moved and Mr. BOOKER seconded, That a penny rate be now struck.

Mr. EDKINS moved and Mr. HARDING seconded, as an amendment, That a halfpenny rate be now struck. The Board divided on the amendment, with the following result:—For: Messrs. Fraser, Edkins, Harding and Looker. Against: Messrs. M'Whannell, Henderson, Booker and Sharwood. The Chairman gave his casting vote in favor of the amendment, which was declared carried, and the motion lost. A halfpenny rate was therefore struck for the year 1892.

Mr. SHARWOOD informed the Board that a movement was on foot in Sub-division No. 1 for separation of part of the Division, and he wished to know whether the Board would assist in giving separation or oppose it.

Mr. BOOKER moved and Mr. LOOKER seconded, "That at present the Board had not sufficient information regarding the wishes of the ratepayers, who will be affected by the proposed alteration of Division, to justify it in pledging itself on the motion."

Mr. HENDERSON moved and Mr. SHARWOOD seconded, as an amendment, "That the Board is not opposed to separation, provided that the majority of the ratepayers are in favor of it."

The Board divided on the amendment, with the following result:—For: Messrs. Henderson, Fraser, Edkins and Sharwood. Against: Messrs. Harding, M'Whannell, Booker and Looker. The Chairman gave his casting vote in favor of the amendment, and declared it carried.

The half-yearly financial statement, as published under the provisions of the Act, was read and adopted.

Resolved, That tenders be called at once for the excavation of, say, three or four thousand yards of earth from the bottom of the waterhole of the Sardine Creek dam; the earth removed to be formed into a dam on the western side of the creek; the whole of the work to be under the supervision of overseer Thompson.

Next meeting to be called, and date fixed by the Clerk, early in October.

A vote of thanks to the chairman terminated the meeting.

The sub-committee appointed earlier in the day, consisting of the members of Sub-division No. 1, met at 8 p.m. and discussed the question of the Iffracombe-Ipsford water supply. It was resolved, That, as there will be sufficient catchment for water in the Iffracombe dam for 12 months for stock and domestic purposes, the question of pump and troughing be deferred, and it is recommended that a fence be erected round the excavation at the top of the bank according to specification, as follows: Posts to be 6 ft. apart; 6 wires, 4 No. 8 with 2 barbed wires.

THE REPORT OF THE LONGREACH INSPECTOR.

Since writing last the weather has been very dry, and consequently the reserves in

getting very bare. All the fencing is in good order, but there is still a way of keeping the stock out. I made an effort last week to do away with some of the many goats running round the town, but after taking the trouble to muster and yard them in the best yard I could find, I had the pleasure of seeing them all out the next day, as there was no means of locking the yard. My brother has submitted a plan to the Colonial Treasurer for erecting a pound yard, &c., which is, I have reason to believe, under favorable consideration, and which I hope to see approved of soon; in which case a yard will very soon be erected, and I shall be able to enforce payment of the fees. I have also to report having wired 4½ miles of fence round reserve, and also erected 1424 posts, and used 2½ coils of wire to put old fence in repair, and had a good pair of gates made and hung on the new fence along the river.

C. W. WEDGEWOOD, Inspector.

Longreach, July 25, 1892.

A Terrible Country.

COVERED WITH SKELETONS.

On the lonely wind-swept island of San Nicholas, 80 miles off the coast of Ventura County, where as far back as the memory of man runs, hundreds of skeletons have dotted the valleys and hillsides, local archeologists are now gathering the relics of a strange extinct race. The island is ten miles long and oval in shape, being four miles across the widest part. Strange utensils of serpentine, sandstone and steatite are found there among the human bones, and the island and its erstwhile inhabitants have a history so curious that it is difficult to comprehend. In 1835 the Padres of Santa Barbara, learning that there were but 16 of the strange Indian race then living there, determined to rescue them from the island. They went over in a sloop and succeeded, as they thought, in getting all on board. At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child, and one of the frequent storms of the channel islands springing up, the sloop was driven away without her. The sloop went on the rocks of Point Conception and all on board were lost. Sixteen years later Captain George Nideyer and two men went from the coast on a sloop to hunt otter off San Nicholas. On landing, they were, like Crusoe, astonished to discover human footprints in the sand. They saw no one, however, and a storm compelled them to put to sea. It was two years thereafter, that the adventurous captain revolving in his mind the sight of the footprints in the uncanny island, determined to go and discover and bring over the lonely woman of whom he had vaguely heard. Men accompanied him, and at length they found on the surf-beaten shore a woman with long tawny hair, dressed in a queer garb of colored birdskins, and scraping, with a bone knife, the blubber of a seal. They surrounded and approached her stealthily, and although suddenly confronted, she did not appear in the least afraid, but smiled, and then suddenly falling on her knees, prayed to the sun. The wild woman offered no objection when by signs she was made to understand that she was to go with them in the boat. They reached Santa Barbara across the rough sea, and the first thing the Indian woman saw was a man riding a horse. She had never seen or heard of any object like it, and thought the man and horse were one, and she knelt on the shore and offered her devotions to it. Two weeks after the last inhabitant of rock-ribbed tempest-tossed San Nicholas died from eating food to which she was unaccustomed, furnished by her rescuers, and the curtain fell on her strange race for ever. Wild dogs had eaten her child.

That Great Horse THE JEWEL

Will Stand this Season NEAR LONGREACH.

GOOD Paddock for mares. All mares led to the horse.

The Jewel, by Goldborough from Ida, who is the dam of The Pearl, winner of the Melbourne Cup; The Arrow, winner of Tattersall's Cup; and The Gem, winner of the Great Metropolitan.

Ida, by Vanguard from Io, who is by Sir Hercules from Flora M'vor.

Vanguard, by Arthur from Giggler.

Goldborough is by Fireworks from Sylvia.

Fireworks is by Kelpie from Galslight; Sylvia from Juliet by Fisherman.

Ida is half sister to Corisande, who is the dam of Primrose, Gladiator, Churchill and Chicago.

Niagara, Trenton, Zalenski, Cuiraasier, Wildrose, Frailty, all come from the mighty Io.

Goldborough sired Melos, Merriment, Arsenal, Honeydew, Algerian, and the dams of Abercorn and Trenton.

The highest price ever paid for a yearling in the southern hemisphere, 2500 gns., was paid for a colt out of Primrose, who is a full sister in blood to The Jewel.

Performances.

Won Christmas Gift at Randwick. Won Railway Handicap at Hawkesbury. Ran second for Hawkesbury Handicap, 1½, in 3:37½. Second in the Great Metropolitan; beaten by a head in 3:11½ for the 2 miles.

1 or 2 mares, 8 gns.; 3 mares, same owner, 7 gns. each.

Mares paid for when stinted, when they will be taken home.

Mares missing this season free next year.

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The Millinery Department is replete with the Latest Styles in Hats and Bonnets.

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